2.3.9 Foods to omit

Concentrated sweets, including baby food "desserts", have no place in an infant's diet. They convey no nutrients to support growth, and the extra food energy can promote obesity. Canned vegetables are also inappropriate for infants, as they often contain too much sodium. Honey and corn syrup should never be fed to infants because of the botulism. Infants and even young children cannot safely chew and swallow popcorn, whole grapes, whole beans, hard candies and nuts; they can easily choke on these foods, a risk not worth taking.

SOME INTRESTING FACTS ABOUT INFANTS

- When baby is born their hearing isn't 100% up to par. There is still of fluid which tends to impair somewhat they are able to recognise is this sound of mother's voice. They respond to this sound above all others.
- They may cry a lot but the fact of matter is new born babies don't shed tears! Although the tear ducts and glands are working, they produce just enough to lubricate and protect the babies Eyes. Look for those teardrops to start flowing between 1 and 3 months.
- Since adults are so much taller and wider than a baby you are naturally assume they have more bones right?
- Wrong! Baby is born but 270 bones and by the time he reaches adulthood the number drops to 206! Reason for the loss of bones is due to the fusion of spine and skull as baby grows.
- New-born babies are very near sighted and their vision only allows them to see people and objects that are clear rest when they are within 8 to 12 inches away.

Government Schemes for pregnant and lactating women*

Tamil Nadu government in a move to provide optimal nutrition for pregnant and lactating women, the Tamil Nadu government is all set to increase the benefits given under Dr Muthulakshmi Reddy Maternity Benefit Scheme by ₹5,000. The cash assistance being provided to pregnant mothers under Dr Muthulakshmi Reddy Maternity Benefit Scheme is being further enhanced to ₹18,000 from ₹12,000, said state health department officials. The new guidelines are under process to allot ₹18,000 along with revised nutrition programmes under the scheme. The financial aid of ₹12,000 was being given in three instalments (₹4000) for pregnant women aged 19 years or more on conditional release and restricted for first two deliveries only. However, the conditional release is being updated coupled with new nutrition plans and is likely to be implemented in April, said public health director Dr K Kolandaisamy. Every pregnant woman below poverty line who avails all required antenatal services during pregnancy in concerned primary health centre can benefit from the scheme. Mothers who deliver in government institutions and complete immunization for the child up to third dose of vaccinations under universal immunization programme are given the cash assistance. Other conditions are being upgraded and will be implemented shortly, state health department officials. The registration of pregnant women is mandatory with the 'Pregnant and Infant Cohort Monitoring and Evaluation (PICME)' portal that generates a 12-digit 'Reproductive and Child Health' (RCH) ID number and the entries to avail the benefit can be done only for the mothers having PICME number with her during delivery. A total of 25,698 pregnant women received cash assistance of `21.76 crore under Dr Muthulakshmi Reddy Maternity Benefit Scheme in the last two years in the districts of Tamil Nadu government.

***Refers to (NOT FOR EXAMINATION).**

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